

MICRO-SAAS MARKET REVIEW · SESSION 3

# Where the revenue actually sits in the indie SaaS long tail

A diagnostic of 1,000 revenue-verified startups: concentration, category economics and acquisition pricing

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Prepared 30 July 2026 | Data frozen 30 Jul 2026 | Internal discussion document

# Four findings define the opportunity

## 01 Revenue is extremely concentrated

10 companies hold 48% of the \$13.5M pooled MRR; the top 50 hold 71%. The median company earns \$282 MRR — the market is a lottery, not a ladder.

## 02 AI is the volume leader, not the value leader

AI is 20% of companies and \$1.8M MRR, but its median (\$446) trails Education (\$2,142) and Marketing (\$1,586). Crowding has compressed per-company economics.

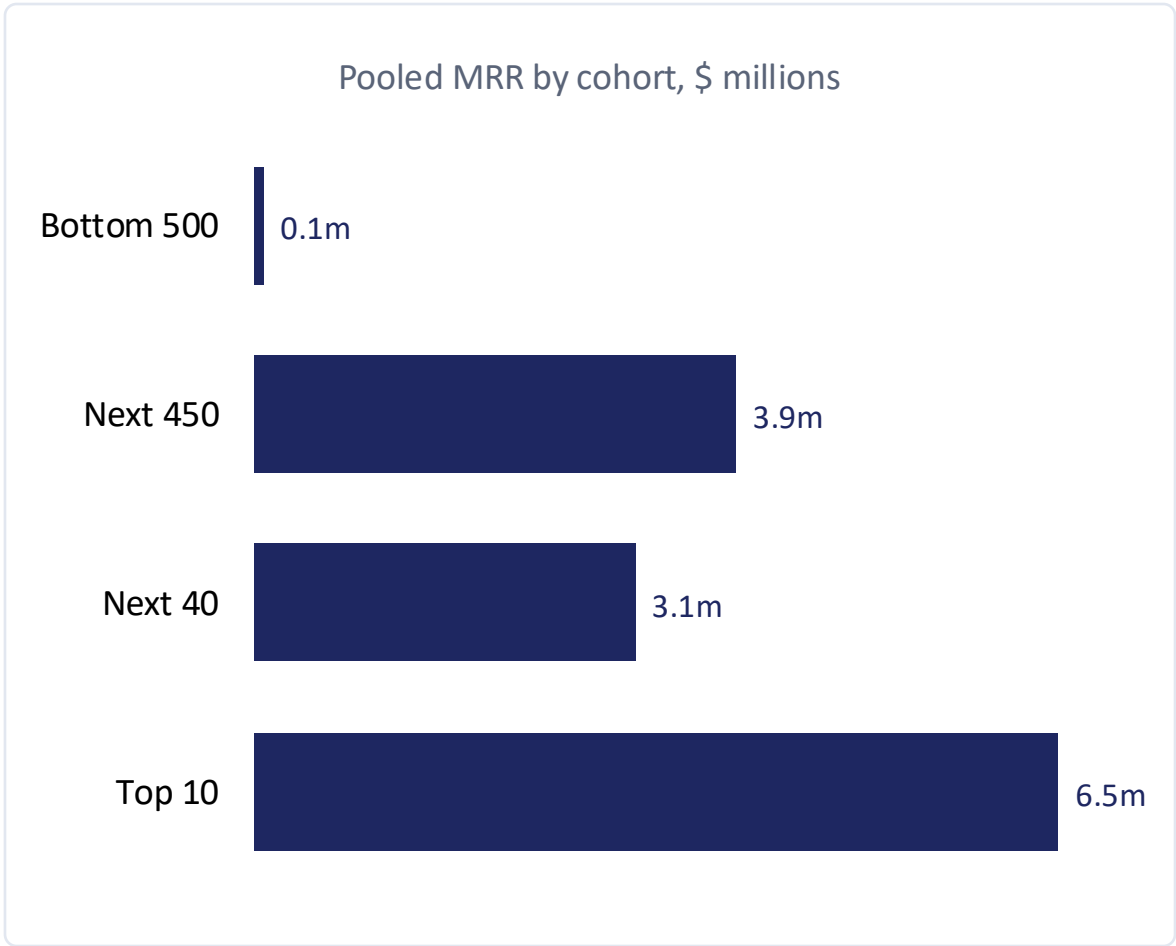
## 03 B2B monetises ~5.7x better than B2C

Median MRR of \$1,036 vs \$181, on 255 vs 401 companies. Audience choice is the single strongest observable driver of revenue per company.

## 04 Assets are cheap and thinly priced

262 of 1,000 are for sale at a median \$35k and 2.3x revenue — a buyer's market concentrated in sub-\$10k MRR assets.

# Half the market's revenue sits in ten companies



**48%**

of pooled MRR held by the top 10 companies

**71%**

held by the top 50 — a classic power-law tail

**59%**

of companies earn under \$1,000 MRR

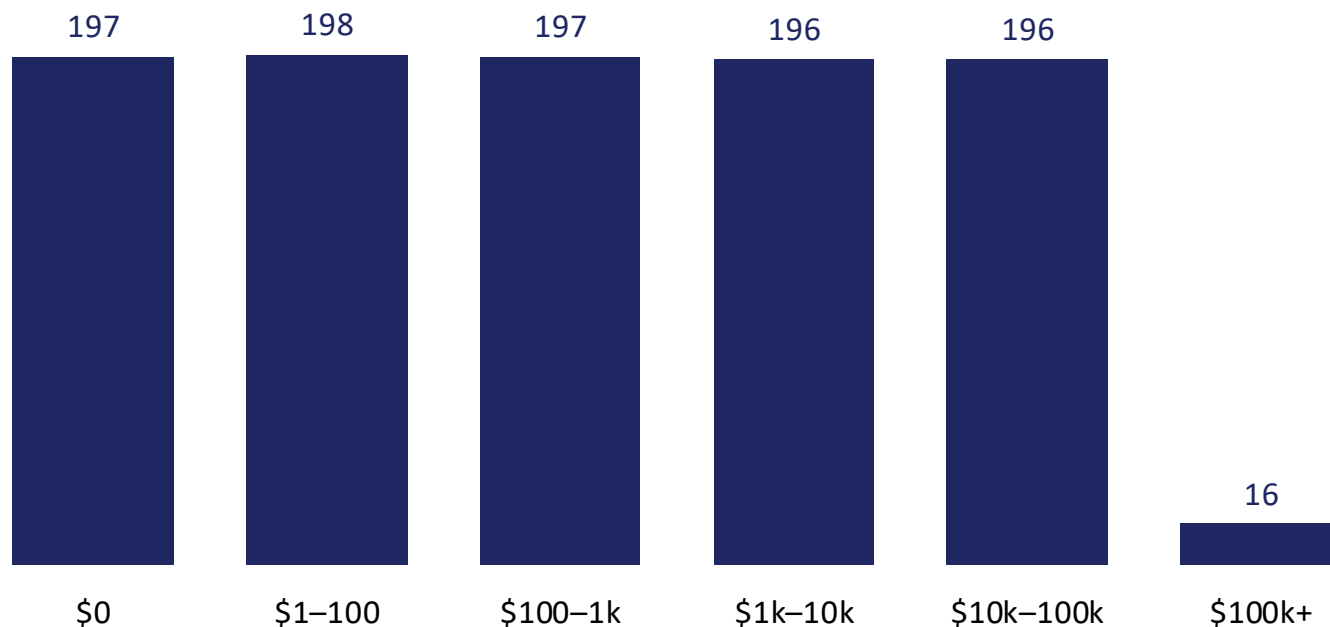
**197**

companies report zero revenue in the window

*Implication: benchmark against the cohort you are in, not the headline names.*

# A hobby at the median, a mirage at the mean

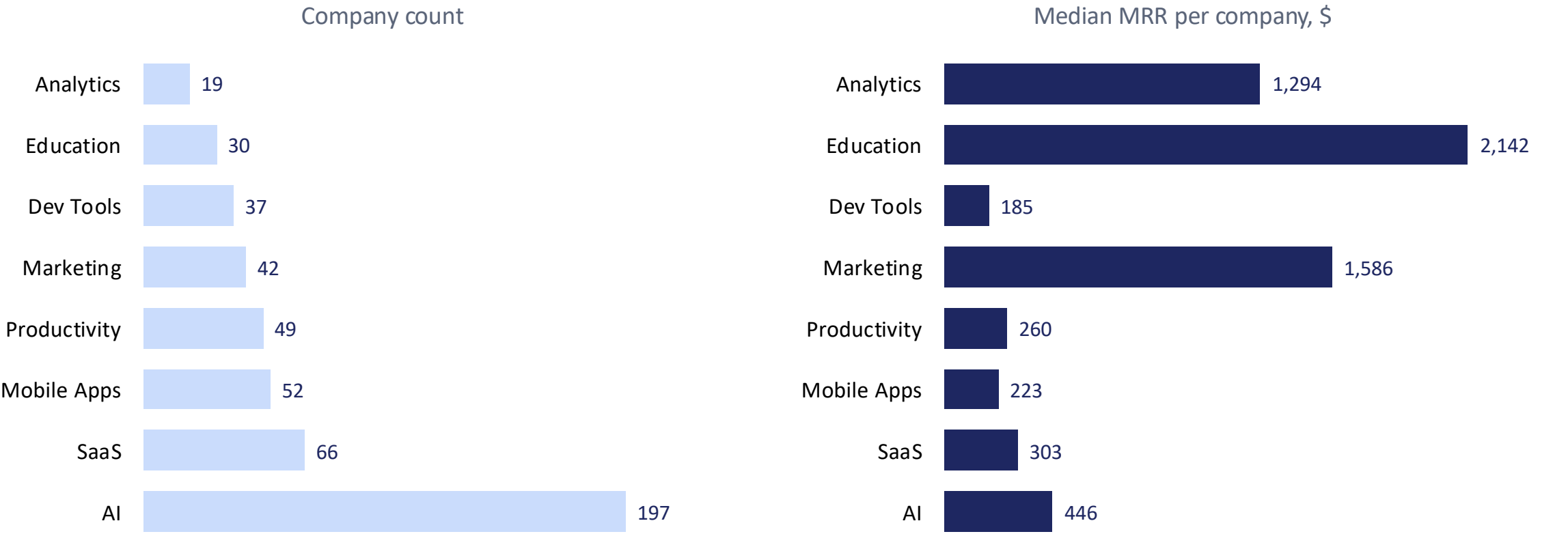
Number of companies by monthly recurring revenue band



## Reading the tail

- Median MRR \$282
- Mean MRR \$13,472
- Only 212 companies clear \$10k MRR
- 16 companies clear \$100k and carry 55% of all MRR
- Mean-based benchmarking overstates a typical business by ~48x

# AI wins on count; other categories win on money



*Productivity median MRR \$260 vs AI \$446: high-volume consumer categories cluster at the bottom of the value curve.*

## THE MONETISATION GAP

# B2B earns 5.7x the median of B2C

### B2B

**\$1,036**

median MRR

255 companies

\$3.35M pooled MRR

25% of market revenue from 26% of companies

### B2C

**\$181**

median MRR

401 companies

\$2.05M pooled MRR

Largest cohort, weakest unit economics

### Both

**\$352**

median MRR

56 companies

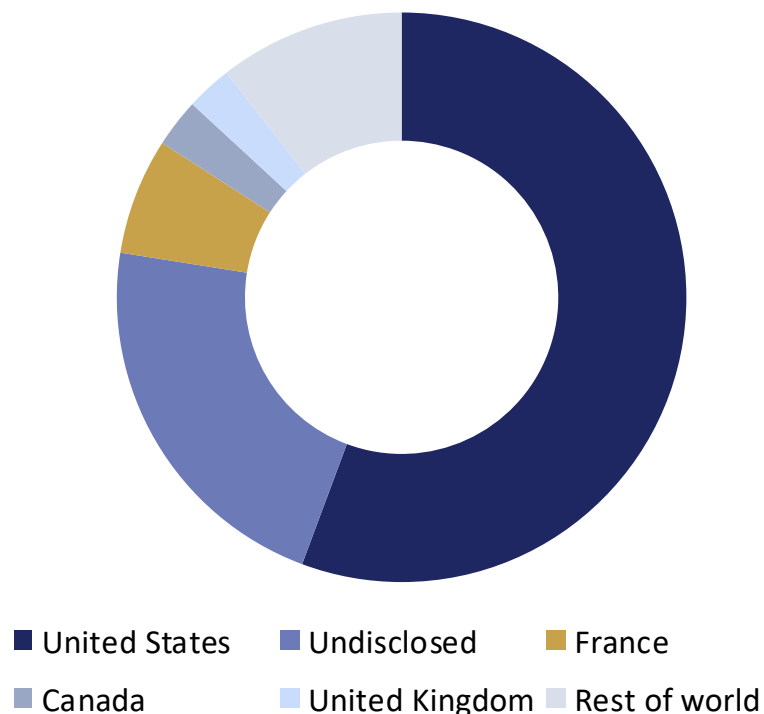
\$0.34M pooled MRR

Hybrid positioning lands in between

So what: for a founder choosing between an equally sized B2B and B2C idea, the B2B path is worth roughly five times more revenue per company at the median.

# US concentration, and distribution beats audience

Pooled MRR by country, \$ millions



## Domain authority correlates with revenue

Spearman  $\rho = 0.49$  between domain rating and MRR — distribution, not product novelty, separates the tail from the top.

## Social following does not

X followers show only  $\rho = 0.17$  versus MRR. Audience size is a weak proxy for monetisation.

## Stripe dominates the money

636 of 1,000 companies use Stripe, with a median MRR of \$663 versus \$237 on RevenueCat and near-zero on newer processors.

# A buyer's market: 26% listed at 2.3x revenue

**262**

companies listed for sale

of 1,000 in the dataset

**\$35k**

median asking price

25th–75th: \$5k–\$220k

**2.3x**

median revenue multiple

vs 4.9x at the 75th percentile

**\$1,055**

median MRR of listed  
assets

vs \$187 for unlisted

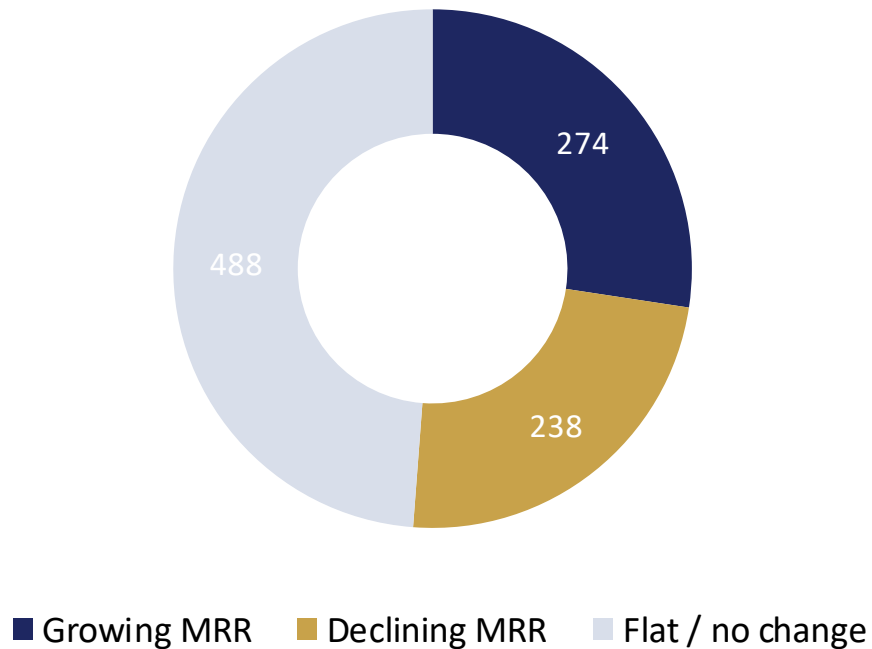
## What this means for a buyer

- Pricing is inconsistent, not efficient. Multiples span 0.0x to 326x on the same board — diligence, not screening, creates the edge.
- Listed assets are 5.6x larger than unlisted ones at the median, so the for-sale pool is a filtered, better-performing subset.
- At a \$35k median ticket, a portfolio of 8–10 sub-\$5k MRR assets is affordable; returns depend on distribution assets (domain rating) more than product.



# Growth is a coin flip; averages mislead

30-day MRR movement, company count



**+41.9%**

mean 30-day revenue growth — inflated by companies restarting from a near-zero base

**0.0%**

median 30-day growth: half the market is standing still

**-11% /  
+11%**

interquartile range of monthly growth — typical movement is modest in both directions

*Use medians for goal-setting; mean growth in this dataset is a base-effect artefact.*

# Three moves over the next two quarters

## MOVE 1 • NOW

### Reposition toward B2B

Target the categories with proven per-company economics — Education, Marketing, Analytics — where the median business earns 4–7x an AI consumer tool.

## MOVE 2 • 90 DAYS

### Buy distribution, not ideas

Domain authority is the strongest observable revenue correlate ( $\rho = 0.49$ ). Acquire or build ranked domains before adding product surface area.

## MOVE 3 • 180 DAYS

### Run a disciplined roll-up

Screen the 262 listed assets for >\$1k MRR at <2.5x revenue; the median \$35k ticket makes a 6–10 asset portfolio realistic at modest capital.

*Risk to test: the dataset is self-reported and revenue-verified only for connected processors; 197 zero-revenue records may understate early-stage activity.*

# Top 10 companies by monthly recurring revenue

| Company         | Category      | MRR (\$)  | 30d revenue (\$) | Country |
|-----------------|---------------|-----------|------------------|---------|
| Stan            | Creator tools | 3,569,654 | 2,844,652        | US      |
| Undisclosed     | Not stated    | 747,069   | —                | —       |
| GojiberryAI     | AI            | 494,668   | —                | —       |
| Undisclosed     | Not stated    | 364,101   | 365,047          | —       |
| Rezi            | AI            | 259,701   | 242,368          | US      |
| Kibu            | Education     | 234,319   | —                | —       |
| Cometly         | Analytics     | 207,616   | 221,991          | US      |
| 1Lookup         | SaaS          | 207,064   | —                | —       |
| Undisclosed     | Not stated    | 191,268   | —                | —       |
| Brand On Demand | E-comm        | 187,459   | 984,522          | US      |

*Dashes indicate fields not populated in the frozen dataset.*